

UTT Chapter 14 Assignment

Hello there!

I have to tell you about the festival on campus yesterday. Several of the engineering groups host an event every year where students can get free food, compete on obstacle courses, and watch movies. Apparently, it is a promotion for exercise and mental health awareness. It was awesome! Mark and I battled each other in the gladiator games. I had a blast! Oh, I almost forgot to mention that they had a petting zoo of sorts. Some local farmers brought lambs and horses, and a few animal shelters brought puppies and kittens for the college students to play with. Sarah and Paige spent most of their time with the animals while Mark and I were busy running through the obstacles. I needed a fun-filled day with midterms looming in the near future!

Speaking of midterms and classes, my Political Theory course has been discussing the foundations of governmental forms and the histories behind many of them. We have been reading a good deal of Locke, Hobbes, Montesquieu, and Rousseau. The theme this week has been on the foundation of law. I can't believe how many different theories there are for explaining what law is and why it exists! I hadn't really thought about it much. As part of the class, students are required to give a presentation on one of these theories, and Muhammad presented yesterday. His talk was about the Islamic perspective on law and the value of shariah law.

After class, Muhammad, Sarah, and I grabbed coffee to talk more about it. Muhammad explained that Islamic law is divine law and is coeternal with Allah. He said there are a great deal of similarities between shariah and the laws in Christianity. Sarah explained her view of law was based on something called positivism. According to her, natural law cannot exist because God does not exist. As she sees it, laws are only man-made constructions that emerged from the cultural, economic, political, and social institutions of each society. I guess I was quiet throughout the conversation because Muhammad and Sarah asked me what I thought about law and its construction. To be honest, I didn't really know what to say. I mumbled something about obeying God, but it didn't seem to satisfy them. Muhammad pointed out how we both agree on divine law, but I feel like there must be something different between Christian and Islamic views on law.

I left the conversation a bit befuddled. Maybe you can help me. After listening to Sarah speak, I would like to know more about her worldview. **What is the basis of law in Secularist thought?** I am assuming that Mark would agree with her, but I am not sure. **How does Marxism view law?** Paige always describes Postmodernism as the rejection of metanarratives and absolute truth. I bet that shapes what her view of the role of law in society. **What is the foundation of law in Postmodernism?** Perhaps most confusing for me is the relationship between Christianity and Islam. **What are the differences between Islam and Christianity's view of law?**

Thank you so much for your help. I don't know what I would do without you!
Later!

-Doug